NEP-2020 School Readiness Index (SRI)

Project Kshitij | Research framing–Version 1.0 (Internal)

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1. Purpose and scope

The **NEP-2020 School Readiness Index (SRI)** is designed as a **structured synthesis of signals**, not as a test score or a compliance checklist. Its purpose is to help schools, leaders, and system actors understand **what kind of NEP-aligned change is currently possible in a school and why**.

SRI does not assess "quality" or rank schools. It surfaces **readiness conditions** that shape whether NEP-2020 intent can translate into consistent classroom practice and learner experience, particularly in **resource-constrained and home-language medium contexts**.

This document presents the **research framing, hypothesis, constructs, and methodology** for SRI as implemented under **Project Kshitij**.

2. Core framing: Readiness as a moving construct

NEP-2020 readiness is not a static attribute. It **emerges over time** through the interaction of multiple layers:

- intent and orientation,
- classroom practice depth,
- teacher cognitive capacity,
- school enablement and routines,
- reflection trajectories,
- parent experience, and
- early student learning signals.

No single instrument can capture readiness. Each questionnaire, survey, diagnostic, or log functions as an **instrument that surfaces a specific signal**. Readiness is understood only by examining how these signals **co-exist, align, contradict, and evolve**.

Design guardrails (non-negotiable):

- No single signal dominates.
- Early signals are not over-weighted.
- Trajectory matters more than absolute values.
- Contradictions are treated as insight, not error.
- False precision, ranking temptation, and premature conclusions are explicitly avoided.

Accordingly, **SRI** represents readiness in motion, not a frozen score.

3. Conceptual anchor: Learner self-direction ("Learn to Learn")

At the heart of NEP-2020 lies a behavioural shift—from passive reception to **learner self-direction ("learn to learn")**.
SRI does **not** measure learner agency directly. Instead, it interprets **school readiness** by examining whether classroom and system conditions consistently support learning behaviours associated with:

- comprehension,
- curiosity,
- critical thinking,
- collaboration.

These behaviours are treated as **emergent outcomes of classroom culture**, not as isolated skills or assessment targets.

4. Foundational principles and practice depth

4.1 Foundational principles (FPs) as orientation lenses

SRI operationalises NEP-2020 through five **Foundational Principles (FP1–FP5)**, used consistently across Kshitij instruments:

- FP1: Every Child is Unique
- FP2: Holistic, Experiential Learning
- FP3: Teacher as Reflective Practitioner
- FP4: Assessment for Learning
- FP5: Collaboration & Community

In SRI, these principles function as **lenses of attention**—revealing where leadership and teachers naturally focus when making everyday decisions.

Orientation reflects **intent and priority**, not behaviour.

4.2 Practice depth as enactment maturity

Orientation alone does not ensure readiness. SRI therefore introduces **practice depth** as a second, orthogonal axis that captures *how* principles are enacted in classrooms.

Practice Depth Bands (internal mapping):

Band	Label	Classroom Meaning
D1	Procedural	Rule-based, default, surface action
D2	Responsive	Adjusts based on situation
D3	Diagnostic	Uses evidence to decide next steps
D4	Adaptive	Intentionally redesigns practice

NEP-2020 readiness depends on **depth progression**, not adoption. Movement from D1/D2 toward D3/D4 indicates increasing capacity for learner self-direction.

5. SRI Hypothesis

Hypothesis

Schools that demonstrate stronger alignment across **orientation (intent), classroom practice depth, teacher cognitive capacity, and system enablement** are more likely to create classroom conditions that support **learner self-direction ("learn to learn")** over time.

In such schools, NEP-2020 Foundational Principles are not only endorsed but enacted with increasing depth—shifting from procedural and responsive practices toward diagnostic and adaptive practices. This progression enables comprehension, curiosity, critical thinking, and collaboration to emerge as **consistent learning behaviours**, rather than as isolated activities.

Conversely, **mismatches across signals**—for example, high intent with low practice depth, strong teacher capacity with weak system support, or active practices without reflection—are expected and treated as meaningful indicators of **readiness constraints**, not failure. SRI is designed to surface these patterns early, enabling targeted, low-friction interventions before large-scale reforms or investments are attempted.

6. What SRI Is — and Is Not

SRI is

- A **sense-making framework** for NEP-2020 readiness.
- A synthesis of multiple, independently valid signals.
- A tool to identify **where change is currently possible**.
- An input to **micro-interventions and playbook creation**.

SRI is not

- A school rating or ranking system.
- A teacher evaluation tool.

- A compliance checklist.
- A proxy for infrastructure or funding adequacy.

SRI does not answer *"How good is a school?"*
It helps answer *"What kind of NEP-aligned change is currently possible in this school—and why?"*

7. Methodology Overview

7.1 Signal types used in SRI

Project Kshitij generates **seven index-ready signal types**:

1. **Orientation Signals**
   Leader and teacher attention across FP1–FP5.
2. **Practice Depth Signals**
   D1–D4 distributions across FPs.
3. **Teacher Cognitive Capacity**
   Baseline and post-practice diagnostics.
4. **System Enablement Signals**
   Teacher (experience lens) and leader (structure lens).
5. **Practice Trajectory Signals**
   Reflection consistency and content during logging cycles.
6. **Validation Signals**
   Parent-reported experience of learning communication and partnership.
7. **Early Impact Signals**
   Sample-based student cognitive and competency indicators.

Each signal is first treated independently. No early aggregation occurs.

7.2 Two-layer index design

Layer 1: Signal Normalisation (No Judgement)

Each signal is converted into a **directional indicator**, not a performance score.

Examples:

- Orientation → attention density
- Practice → depth distribution
- Cognition → capacity band
- Reflection → consistency index
- Parent → experience alignment
- Student → cognitive demand exposure

At this layer:

- Aggregation is avoided.
- Weighting is avoided.
- Variance is preserved.

Layer 2: Readiness Constructs

Only after normalisation are signals grouped into five **readiness constructs**:

Construct	Signals Contributing
Intent Readiness	Leader + teacher orientation
Practice Readiness	Practice depth + reflection
Capacity Readiness	Teacher cognition (pre/post)
System Readiness	Enablement + leadership routines
Ecosystem Readiness	Parent + student signals

This structure preserves NEP philosophy while allowing pattern interpretation.

8. Scoring and representation (Guarded use)

SRI **does not require a numeric score** to function.
If representation is needed (for internal communication or comparison), the following guardrails apply:

- Use **bands**, not precise points (e.g., Emerging / Developing / Anchoring / Transforming).

- Score **within constructs**, not across schools initially.
- Allow and highlight mismatches (e.g., high intent + low practice).

Guardrail question (mandatory):
If this number increases by 10%, what real change does it represent in classrooms?
If the answer is unclear, the scoring is invalid.

9. Analytical value of SRI

SRI enables four forms of analysis:

1. **Diagnostic**
   Identifies FP-wise and depth-wise strengths and constraints.
2. **Comparative (Non-Ranking)**
   Pattern comparison across mediums, clusters, or stages—without league tables.
3. **Early Directional Insight**
   Correlates with future learning conditions (e.g., FLN readiness) without causal claims.
4. **Actionable Design**
   Directly informs low-effort, high-leverage micro-interventions focused on depth shifts.

10. Role of SRI in project Kshitij

SRI is **constructed after**, not before:

- orientation baselines,
- practice diagnostics,
- micro-interventions,
- reflection logging,
- and validation cycles.

Its primary downstream output is an **execution-tested, teacher-co-created NEP-2020 Playbook**—not a report card.

11. Closing position

Project Kshitij moves from *measuring* NEP readiness to *understanding how readiness is built*—by observing intent, practice, capacity, systems, reflection, validation, and early impact.

The **SRI is the synthesis point of this understanding**. It makes the invisible visible—without oversimplifying what NEP-2020 implementation truly requires.

Appendix: Path to final SRI index report (post-execution)

To be worked on-Final SRI Index Report (Post-Execution)

A. Side-by-side mapping: Internal SRI v1 → Final index report

SRI v1 (Internal Research backbone)	Final SRI Index Report (External / Stakeholder-Facing)
1. Purpose and Scope	1. Introduction & Context
Explains why SRI exists as a construct	States why project Kshitij was undertaken and what this report presents
Mentions guardrails, false precision	No guardrails; focus on intent, scope, and context
Adapt	Adapt
2. Readiness as a moving Construct	❌ Not a standalone section
Methodological philosophy	Implicit in findings narrative
Remove	Remove
3. Learner Self-Direction ("Learn to Learn")	2. Framing lens for analysis
Conceptual anchor	**Short framing paragraph for interpreting findings**
Adapt	Adapt (short)
4. Foundational Principles (FP1–FP5)	3. Analytical framework (Reference)
Explains FPs conceptually	Mentions FPs as the organising framework
Adapt	Adapt (reference only)
4.2 Practice Depth (D1–D4)	4. Understanding Classroom Practice Depth
Core construct explanation	Essential lens to read findings
Keep (short)	Keep
5. SRI Hypothesis	5. Key questions explored
Hypothesis-driven	Reframed as analytical questions
Adapt	Adapt
6. What SRI Is / Is Not	Not included
Design protection	Credibility shown via evidence
Remove	Remove
7. Methodology Overview	6. Study design & methodology
Index architecture	Sample, instruments, timeline
Adapt	Adapt (condensed)
7.2 Two-Layer Index Design	Technical appendix (if needed)
Internal synthesis logic	Not required for most readers
Remove	Appendix

8. Scoring & Representation Guardrails	7. How to read the Index outputs
Scoring philosophy	Interpreting bands, heatmaps, patterns
Adapt	**Adapt**
9. Analytical Value of SRI	8. Key findings & patterns
What SRI enables analytically	What was observed across schools
Adapt	Keep (as findings)
10. Role of SRI in Kshitij	Not included
Internal execution logic	Execution shown via timeline
Remove	Remove
11. Closing Position	9. Discussion & Implications
Research positioning	What this means for schools, systems
Adapt	Adapt

B. Final SRI index report- section outline

1. Introduction & context

- Why NEP-2020 readiness matters *now*
- Purpose of Project Kshitij
- What this report covers (and does not)

2. Framing lens: Readiness for learner self-direction

- One short paragraph:
  - *"Readiness is interpreted as the ability of schools to create classroom conditions that support learner self-direction ('learn to learn'), reflected through comprehension, curiosity, critical thinking, and collaboration."*

3. Analytical framework (Reference)

- NEP-2020 Foundational Principles (FP1–FP5)
- Practice Depth bands (D1–D4)
- No explanation beyond what is needed to read charts

4. Study design & methodology

- Sample (schools, teachers, leaders)
- Instruments used
- Execution sequence (high-level timeline)
- Data sources (orientation, practice, cognition, systems, reflection, parent, student)

5. Key questions explored

- Where is NEP intent strong or weak?
- How deeply are NEP principles enacted in classrooms?
- Where do intent–practice–system mismatches occur?
- What changed after micro-interventions and reflection cycles?

6. Key Findings

(Core of the report)

Sub-sections likely to include:

- Orientation patterns across FP1–FP5
- Classroom practice depth distributions
- Leader–teacher alignment and misalignment
- Practice trajectory shifts post-intervention
- System enablement constraints
- Parent-validated collaboration signals
- Early student cognitive signals (sample-based)

7. How to read the index outputs

- Explanation of bands / heatmaps / profiles
- What comparisons mean (and don't mean)
- Why this is not a ranking

8. Implications

- For school leadership
- For teacher development
- For NEP-2020 implementation at system level
- What kind of change is feasible next

9. Conclusion

- What Project Kshitij reveals about NEP-2020 readiness
- Why readiness must be built, not assumed
- How SRI supports continuous, grounded implementation

C. Draft executive Summary (To be refined post execution)

Executive Summary (Draft – To Be Finalised)

Project Kshitij was undertaken to understand how ready schools are to implement NEP-2020 in practice—not as a policy intent, but as a lived classroom reality. Rather than relying on a single metric or compliance checklist, the study examined NEP-2020 readiness as a layered and evolving construct, shaped by leadership intent, classroom practices, teacher cognitive capacity, system enablement, reflection habits, parent experience, and early student learning signals.

Using a multi-signal School Readiness Index (SRI), the study analysed data from ___ schools and ___ teachers across ___ contexts. Findings reveal that while NEP-2020 intent is widely present, its translation into classroom practice varies significantly in depth. In many cases, practices remain procedural or responsive, with diagnostic and adaptive practices emerging only where reflection, cognitive capacity, and system support align.

The analysis highlights recurring intent–practice gaps, particularly in assessment for learning and collaboration, alongside pockets of strong practice that operate despite limited system enablement. Micro-interventions combined with structured reflection demonstrated that meaningful shifts in practice depth are possible

without large structural changes, provided conditions for trust, focus, and support are in place.

Overall, the findings suggest that NEP-2020 readiness is less about infrastructure or adoption of new tools, and more about **the alignment of intent, practice depth, capacity, and systems over time**. The SRI provides a practical way to surface these patterns early, enabling schools and system actors to design targeted, low-friction interventions that make sustained NEP-aligned change possible.

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